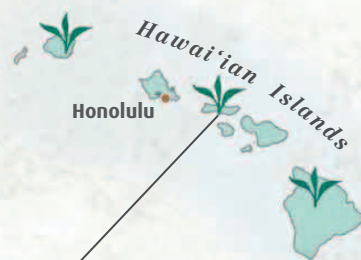


UNITED STATES OF AMERICA

Due to geographically varied tea-growing zones and climatic contrasts, tea cultivation has been a challenge for the US. However, investment in tea farms throughout the country is boosting tea production.

In the 1880s, the US government began to experiment with tea growing in the states of Georgia and South Carolina. These farms failed within the first few decades owing to climate problems or the high cost of production. Since then, a number of farms around the country have been planting tea with positive results. One in particular, the Charleston Tea Plantation in South Carolina, is well established and provides the official tea of the White House. The soil conditions and temperature ranges across the country make it difficult to plan

for consistent harvests, so farmers are experimenting with various cultivars of tea plants to see which will thrive in their climate. Most of the 900 acres (364 hectares) of tea plantations in the US are planted in coastal states to benefit from the cooling ocean breeze. Farms in South Carolina, Alabama, California, Oregon, Washington, and Hawaii have had productive harvests and have begun to sell their tea. Newer farms in Mississippi have thriving plants, and are set to harvest the leaves in a few years.



HAWAII

There are 50 small tea farms occupying 50 acres (20 hectares) around the islands of Hawaii, most of them located on the "Big Island." The rich volcanic soil, mountainous terrain, and abundant rainfall are well-suited to the artisanal white, green, black, and oolong teas produced. Hawaiian tea is among the highest priced in the world. A Hawaiian tea farm has sold its tea to Harrods department store in London for \$10,750 per kilo.

US KEY FACTS

PERCENTAGE
OF WORLD
PRODUCTION: **0.009%**

MAIN
TYPES: **BLACK,**
GREEN, OOLONG

HARVEST:
APRIL–OCTOBER

FAMOUS FOR:
TEA FARM START-UPS
WITH GARDENS
RANGING IN SIZE
FROM 1-200 ACRES
(1-81 HECTARES)

ELEVATION:
LOW–HIGH



COOL TEMPERATURES

This Mississippi tea farm is attempting to cultivate plants that will adjust to cold temperatures. These young cuttings will be ready to harvest in 3-4 years.